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— STRATEGY DOCUMENT

How to Leverage the AI E-Commerce Ops System for Your Portfolio

A playbook for turning the 7-workflow system into leads, authority, and income — packaging it as a portfolio asset, a service offering, and a content engine.

Written June 2026 · Juan Paolo Blanco

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SECTION 01

What You Actually Built — and Why It Matters

Before positioning it, understand the real value on the table.

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AI Workflows

5+

Integrations

24/7

Monitoring

~0

Human Hours/wk

Most e-commerce businesses are drowning in operational tasks that feel urgent but are entirely automatable. What you built is not a "cool demo" — it's a **functioning operations department replacement** that runs for less than \$50/month in API costs.

The system covers the full ops stack:

- / **W1 — Ad Performance Monitor:** Checks Meta Ads every 6 hours, fires alerts if ROAS or spend drops past a threshold. Most brands pay a media buyer \$3–5k/month to do this manually.
- / **W2 — Support Inbox Triage:** Reads incoming emails, classifies urgency, escalates high-priority tickets. Saves 2–3 hours daily for a solo operator.
- / **W3 — Refund Spike Detector:** Monitors Shopify refund rate, uses AI to identify root causes (product issue? fulfilment delay? bad ad creative?). Proactive instead of reactive.
- / **W4 — Revenue Intelligence Report:** Every Monday, generates and sends a full P&L summary with trend analysis. Replaces a weekly analytics ritual.
- / **W5 — Inventory Intelligence:** Monitors stock levels, predicts stockouts, alerts on low inventory with reorder suggestions.
- / **W6 — Customer Sentiment Monitor:** Scrapes reviews or support tickets, uses AI to detect sentiment shifts before they become PR problems.
- / **W7 — AI Ops Chatbot:** Slack bot that answers business questions in real time using live Shopify data — "What were our top 5 products last week?" answered in seconds.

THE REAL VALUE PROPOSITION

You're not selling automation. You're selling **a junior ops team that never sleeps, never calls in sick, and costs \$50/month to run**. For a 7-figure e-commerce brand, this replaces 15–20 hours of human operations work per week.

Pricing — What This System Is Worth

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Three ways to price it, from one-off project to recurring revenue.

ONE-TIME BUILD

\$3,500 –\$6,000

Custom install, configured for their Shopify store, their Slack, their ad account. Includes 30 days of support.

- ✓ All 7 workflows deployed
- ✓ Credentials configured
- ✓ Training + documentation
- ✓ 30-day support window

Recommended

SETUP + RETAINER

\$2,500 +

\$600/mo

Lower entry price to close the deal, then monthly recurring for maintenance, updates, and AI model improvements.

- ✓ Full setup included
- ✓ Monthly health checks
- ✓ Workflow updates as platform changes
- ✓ Priority support
- ✓ New workflow added quarterly

PRODUCTIZED SAAS

\$299 /mo

Long-term play. White-label the system, charge monthly for access. Needs more infrastructure but scales to many clients.

- ✓ Shared n8n instance
- ✓ Onboarding wizard
- ✓ Dashboard for clients
- ✓ Requires 10+ clients to be viable

ANCHOR PRICING LOGIC

When you present pricing, always anchor to what it replaces. A part-time virtual assistant handling these ops tasks costs **\$800–\$1,500/month**. A fractional COO or ops consultant costs **\$3,000–\$6,000/month**. Your \$600/month retainer sounds like a steal by comparison.

Frame it as: **"This replaces \$1,500/month in VA costs for \$600/month."** The math closes itself.

What Factors Drive the Price Up

FACTOR	PRICE IMPACT	WHY
Store revenue > \$1M/year	+\$1,000–2,000	Higher stakes, more value delivered

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Custom integrations (custom ERPs, non-Shopify)	+\$500–1,500	More dev work and edge cases
Rush timeline (< 2 weeks)	+30% rush fee	Opportunity cost
Multiple stores or markets	+\$500 per store	Multi-tenancy complexity
Ongoing retainer requested	Raises floor to \$600/mo	Continuity premium

SECTION 03

How to Use It as a Portfolio Asset

You've already built the case study page. Here's how to maximize its reach and conversion power.

ALREADY DONE

The case study page (`case-study-ai-ops.html`) is live. It covers the architecture, all 7 workflows, the tech stack, and has a contact form wired to your Gmail. That's your foundation — now drive traffic to it.

What Makes a Case Study Convert

Most portfolio case studies describe *what* was built. The ones that convert leads describe the **business problem solved, the cost of not solving it, and the outcome after**. Your case study already does this — don't make it more technical, make it more specific.

- / Add a "Before vs After" section — What was the store owner doing manually before? How many hours? What does this free them to do?
- / Add a dollar value estimate — "This system handles \$2,400/month worth of operational work."

/ Add social proof — Even one line from someone who tried it ("The weekly revenue report alone saves me 3 hours every Monday.") dramatically increases trust.

/ Add a live demo link — See Section 8 for how to set this up. A working demo is worth 10 screenshots.

Where to Publish and Distribute It



LinkedIn — long-form post

Write a 600–800 word post breaking down how the system works. Don't just share the link — tell the story. "I spent 3 weeks building an AI ops system for a Shopify store. Here's what it does and what I learned." Attach the case study URL in comments (LinkedIn hides reach on posts with external links).



X (Twitter) — thread

A 10-tweet thread: "I built a 7-agent AI system that runs an e-commerce store's entire ops stack. Here's a breakdown, workflow by workflow." Tweet 1 = the hook. Tweets 2–9 = one workflow each with a screenshot or short video. Tweet 10 = CTA to the case study.



Short-form video (Reels/TikTok)

60–90 second screen recording of the chatbot answering a real business question in Slack. Overlay text: "This Slack bot just answered a business question using live Shopify data in 3 seconds. Here's how." Combine your video editing skills with your automation work — that's your unique angle.



Cold email to warm prospects

Find e-commerce brands you admire (or that you know are growing fast). Send a 4-sentence email: problem you noticed → system you built that solves it → link to case study → one specific question to open dialogue. No pitch decks, no long intros.

SECTION 04

Packaging It as a Service Offering

How to turn a portfolio project into a repeatable business.

The mistake most freelancers make is treating each project as custom from scratch. The system you built is **90% reusable across any Shopify store** — the only customization is credentials, thresholds, and Slack workspace. You can deliver a new client in 3–5 days instead of 3–5 weeks.

Name It

Don't say "n8n automation" — that means nothing to a business owner. Name the package:

AI Ops Suite for Shopify

Autonomous Operations System

The Ops Autopilot

Store Intelligence System

Pick one and own it

The Onboarding Checklist (for your own use)

To deliver this to a new client, you need:

- / Shopify store URL and OAuth2 credentials
- / Meta Ads account access (read-only) + ad account ID
- / Gmail account or forwarding address for support inbox workflow
- / Slack workspace invite with permission to create a bot
- / Alert thresholds: ROAS floor, refund rate %, inventory minimums
- / Notification preferences (who gets what, when)

PRODUCTIZATION TIP

Build a Google Form or Typeform that collects all the above in one sitting. Send it after signing the contract — it signals professionalism and reduces back-and-forth. You can then set up the entire system in one focused session instead of chasing credentials over 2 weeks.

Scope Boundaries (protect yourself)

INCLUDED	NOT INCLUDED (QUOTE SEPARATELY)
All 7 workflows deployed and live	Custom integrations beyond Shopify + Meta + Gmail + Slack
Credentials setup and testing	Ongoing content creation or ad management

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NOT INCLUDED (QUOTE SEPARATELY)

30-day bug fixes (retainer: ongoing)

Training sessions beyond initial handover call

Documentation of all workflows

Migrating to a different automation platform

Initial threshold configuration

Building new workflows outside the system scope

SECTION 05

Who to Target — Ideal Client Profile

Not every Shopify store needs or can afford this. Focus on the ones that do.



Sweet Spot Client

Shopify store doing \$300k–\$3M/year. Running Meta Ads. Team of 1–5 people. Owner is overwhelmed by operations and wants to focus on growth. Understands AI tools. Has a Slack workspace or is willing to set one up.



Ideal Growth Client

Scaling brand doing \$1M–\$5M/year with increasing support volume. Struggling with Monday morning reporting rituals. Has tried hiring VAs but keeps running into reliability issues. Has been burned by missed refund spikes or inventory stockouts.



Too Small

Under \$100k/year. Can't justify \$600/month. The system would be overkill, and they'd never see ROI. Better to build relationships and revisit in 6–12 months when they're bigger.



Wrong Fit

Not on Shopify (WooCommerce, BigCommerce requires major rework). Not running paid ads (W1 has no value). Has a full in-house ops team (they'll feel threatened, not helped). Wants to

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own and run the system themselves with no ongoing support.

Where to Find Them

- / **Shopify Partner Directory** — brands actively looking for agency/consultant help
- / **Meta Ads Library** — brands running active ads are investing in growth and have revenue
- / **Micro-influencer brand collabs** — brands doing influencer marketing are usually in the \$500k–\$3M range
- / **r/shopify and r/ecommerce** — people actively complaining about ops problems are qualified leads
- / **LinkedIn: "Head of E-Commerce" or "Shopify Founder"** — filter by company size 1–10 employees
- / **Facebook Groups** — "Shopify Entrepreneurs", "eCommerce Fuel" — high-quality DTC founders

SECTION 06

How to Find and Reach Clients

Three proven outreach approaches that don't feel spammy.

Approach 1: Value-First Cold Email

Find a brand you like. Spend 5 minutes learning about them. Write this email:

Subject: Quick idea for [Brand Name]'s ops

Hey [Name],

I've been following [Brand] — the [specific thing you noticed: product launch / ad creative / growth] caught my attention.

I recently built an AI system that automates the full operations stack for Shopify brands — ad monitoring, support triage, refund detection, weekly reports, and a Slack chatbot that answers business questions using live store data. Most clients recover 15–20 hours/week of ops work.

Here's a 3-minute case study if you're curious: [link]

Would it make sense to chat for 20 minutes?

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WHY THIS WORKS

It's **short, specific, and doesn't ask for anything** in the first message except a "yes/no" to a 20-minute call. The case study link does the selling — your email just earns the click.

Approach 2: LinkedIn Content + DMs

Post 2–3 times per week about automation, e-commerce ops, and the specific problems your system solves. Comment thoughtfully on posts by your ICP. After 2–3 meaningful comments on someone's posts, send a short DM — you're no longer cold.

Approach 3: Community Participation

Spend 30 minutes/week in Shopify or DTC communities (Reddit, Facebook Groups, Discord). When someone posts a problem your system solves, reply with a genuine answer — then mention you built a tool for exactly this. Let them ask you for more information rather than pitching unprompted.

SECTION 07

Content Strategy — Turn It Into Leverage

You have video editing skills AND automation expertise. This is a rare combination — use it to build an audience.

YOUR UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

Most automation consultants can't produce compelling video. Most video editors don't know automation. **You can explain complex systems in a way that's visually engaging** — that's a moat. Use it.

Content Formats That Work

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Screen Recording Shorts (30–90s)

Record the chatbot answering a real question.
Record an alert firing when ROAS drops.
Record the weekly report arriving in Slack. No face cam needed. Add captions + music. These are your most shareable pieces.



LinkedIn Deep-Dives

"I automated [specific thing] so a Shopify founder doesn't have to. Here's exactly how."
Walk through one workflow at a time — one post per workflow = 7 posts from one project. Tag the tools you used (n8n, Shopify, Groq) for extra reach.



Twitter/X Threads

"The 7 things your Shopify store's AI should be doing while you sleep" — one tweet per workflow. These get shared by automation and e-commerce audiences simultaneously.



Blog / SEO Content

Long-term play. Write detailed posts: "How to automate Shopify refund monitoring with n8n and AI" — these rank in Google and bring inbound leads for years. Repurpose each section of your case study into a standalone article.

Content Calendar Skeleton (Weekly)

DAY	FORMAT	TOPIC
Monday	LinkedIn post	One workflow deep-dive (rotate through 7)
Wednesday	Short video (Reels/TikTok/X)	Live demo clip of the system in action
Friday	LinkedIn or X thread	Lesson learned, hot take, or tool comparison

This is 3 pieces/week. With your video skills, the video takes 30–45 minutes to produce. The text posts take 20 minutes each. That's under 2 hours/week for a consistent content presence that compounds over time.

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Setting Up a Live Demo Environment

A live demo closes deals faster than any case study or screenshot.

The chatbot is your most impressive piece to demo because it's interactive. Here's how to let prospects try it themselves without giving them access to a client's real store:

1

Set up a Shopify development store

Shopify gives you a free development store. Populate it with sample products and fake orders. This becomes your permanent demo environment — you own it, no client data is exposed.

2

Wire the chatbot to a public-accessible endpoint

Your n8n webhook is already live at n8n.jpabloblanco.online. Set up a stripped-down version of W7 that prospects can query via a simple web form on your portfolio or case study page.

3

Add a "Try the Demo" widget to the case study page

A simple chat input on the case study page that fires a question at the demo chatbot and returns the answer inline. Takes 1–2 hours to build. The conversion boost is massive — prospects go from "interesting" to "I need this."

4

Prepare 3–4 scripted demo questions

Populate your demo store with data that makes compelling answers: top-selling products, a recent order spike, a low-inventory item. Then show: "Top 3 products by revenue this month" / "Which item is almost out of stock?" / "How many orders came in last week?"

5

Record it as a video fallback

If the live demo ever has downtime during a pitch, have a 2-minute screen recording as a backup. Record a clean version with good audio and captions — this doubles as content for your social channels.

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Objections You'll Hear and How to Handle Them

Every sales conversation has predictable resistance. Prepare for it.

OBJECTION	WHAT THEY MEAN	YOUR RESPONSE
"That's expensive."	They haven't connected the price to the value.	Anchor to cost of alternatives: "A part-time VA handling this work costs \$900–\$1,200/month and works 8 hours/day. This runs 24/7 for \$600/month."
"What if it breaks?"	They're worried about dependency on a system they don't understand.	"All workflows are documented, you own the n8n instance, and the retainer includes monitoring and fixes. If I'm hit by a bus, you can hire any n8n developer to maintain it."
"We already use Klaviyo/Gorgias/etc."	They're not sure this replaces or complements their existing tools.	"This doesn't replace those — it connects them. The system can read from Gorgias for support triage and push data to Klaviyo. Think of it as the layer that makes your tools talk to each other."
"I'd need to see it working first."	Totally fair. They want proof before committing.	Pull up the demo. If you have the interactive chatbot working, offer 5 minutes right now. If not, offer a 30-minute screenshare call where you show it live on the demo store.
"We're not ready right now."	Timing issue, not a no.	"No problem — when would 'ready' look like? If it's a budget cycle issue, I have a lighter starter package at \$1,500 that covers just the monitoring and reporting workflows."
"Can't I just use Zapier/Make?"	They've heard of alternatives and wonder why they need you.	"You could, but the AI reasoning layers — the refund root-cause analysis, the chatbot answering natural language questions — those require what I built on top. Off-the-shelf tools handle data transfer. This handles thinking."

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The 90-Day Execution Roadmap

A concrete sequence to go from "I have a portfolio project" to "I have paying clients."

1 Days 1–14: Foundation

Finalize the case study page (done ✓). Set up the demo store. Record a 2-minute demo video of the chatbot in action. Write a LinkedIn post announcing you're taking on clients for this service.

2 Days 15–30: First Outreach Wave

Identify 20 Shopify brands in your target range. Send the value-first cold email to 5 per week. Post on LinkedIn and X 3×/week. Join 2 e-commerce communities and start contributing (not pitching).

3 Days 31–60: First Client

Your goal is one paying client by day 60. Offer the first client a 20% discount in exchange for a video testimonial. Document the entire delivery process — how long it took, what issues came up — to improve the productized workflow.

4 Days 61–90: Systematize and Scale

Add the client testimonial to the case study page and your LinkedIn profile. Refine the onboarding checklist. Start the second outreach wave targeting 20 more brands. Increase content to 4×/week — the first 60 days of posts are now warming up your audience.

THE ONLY METRIC THAT MATTERS IN MONTH 1

Don't measure LinkedIn impressions or website visits. Measure **conversations started**. Every week you should be having at least 2–3 conversations with potential clients — whether that's a DM, a reply to your cold email, or a comment that turns into a chat. If you're not getting conversations, your outreach message needs work, not your volume.

Revenue Projection

SCENARIO	MONTH 3	MONTH 6	MONTH 12
1 new client/month × \$2,500 setup + \$600 retainer	\$2,500 + \$600 MRR	\$2,500 + \$3,600 MRR	\$2,500 + \$7,200 MRR

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2 new clients/month (after referrals kick in)	\$5,000 + \$1,200 MRR	\$5,000 + \$7,200 MRR	\$5,000 + \$14,400 MRR
Productized at \$299/mo (10+ clients)	—	\$2,990 MRR	\$5,980–\$8,970 MRR

The retainer model is the play. Each client you land is compounding monthly revenue — not a one-and-done project. **5 clients on retainer = \$3,000/month recurring** while you keep taking on new builds.

FINAL NOTE

You built something real. A lot of people talk about "AI automation" without having shipped anything that runs in production. You have a live system, a case study, and working code. That's already more than 90% of the people competing in this space.

The only missing piece is telling enough people about it, consistently, until one of them says yes. The tech is done. The work now is the outreach.